

IT IS TIME TO TRUST THE LORD

(Empowerment 2020)

TEXT: Proverbs 3:5-6 (NKJV) *“Trust in the Lord with all your heart, And lean not on your own understanding; ⁶ In all your ways acknowledge Him, And He shall direct your paths.”*

INTRO: Trust is a big deal. Nothing much happens in life without trust:

- Marriage...
- Parenting...
- Partnerships...
- Business relationships...

Trust = (Dictionary.com) *“Reliance on the integrity, strength, ability, surety, etc., of a person or thing; confidence. Confident expectation of something; hope.”*

The writer of Proverbs is telling us to *“Rely upon or have confidence in the ability of God to*

bring a thing to pass.” We are not just to simply rely upon God to bring a thing to pass, but to do so with **“*all our heart.*”** We are to THROW ourselves upon Him, heart, soul, and mind!

We are also being encouraged to not lean upon our rational, emotional, way of doing things. If, in difficult times we can do this, **“*He will direct our steps.*”** In other words, if we can shut down our rationality long enough to go with whatever God is saying and doing, He will lead us into a Holy setup!

When we are encountering difficulty, if we TRUST the Lord, He will cause **“*All things to work together for our good.*”** I say it is time to trust the Lord!

Let me give you a three part life changing truth that I believe the Holy Spirit spoke to my heart as I was preparing this sermon:

- *Fear is the thing that will keep us from God’s purpose...* Paul Torner in his book,

The Strong and the Weak, says *“All of us have reservoirs of full potential, vast areas of great satisfaction but the roads that lead to those reservoirs are guarded by the dragon called fear”*. We all have great potential. The trouble is that the potential God has given us is guarded by a dragon called fear. What would you go home and do if you were not afraid of people or afraid of failure? As men and women of God, we must slay the dragon called fear. (Fear as an emotion vs. fear as a spirit.) ***“We have not been given a spirit of bondage again to fear, but of power and a sound mind.”***

- *Faith is the ingredient that will free us from our fears...* We must use our words of faith, based on our unwavering trust in God and His Word, to move what we need from the heavenly realm into the earthly realm.
- *Trust is what proves we have faith...* A lack of trust is why; progress is stymied; goals are not reached; leaders don't lead; people

don't give; and kingdom projects are not being initiated.

It is time to trust the Lord and go for the goal!

WE MUST TRUST THAT GOD BROUGHT US HERE...

If we truly believe that *“The steps of good people are ordered by the Lord,”* we must believe, it is by His will that we find ourselves this difficult place. In that fact, we will rest, because we trust Him! (Moses on the backside of the desert – For forty years, Moses was doing his doctorate work, in preparation for Pastoring the First Church of the Wilderness) It is in the difficult places that God is getting us ready to accomplish Kingdom business.

Corrie Ten Boom said, *“Never be afraid to trust an unknown future to a known God.”* The past behavior of the Lord is a good indicator of His present and future actions. Paul said, *“He hath delivered. He doth deliver. He will yet deliver.”*

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**WE MUST TRUST GOD TO KEEP US
WHILE WE ARE IN THIS DIFFICULT
PLACE...**

If we are in a difficult place because we have been led there by the Lord, we must also know that He will keep us, despite the attacks of the enemy! No matter the level of difficulty, He will give us enough grace to behave as an obedient child. (Paul – *“My grace is sufficient for you – My strength is made perfect in weakness.”*)

Martin Luther said, *“Pray and let God worry.”*

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**WE WILL TRUST GOD TO TURN THIS
DIFFICULT PLACE INTO A BLESSING...**

It is often in the difficult places that He teaches us the lessons He intends for us to learn. (Joseph said, *“The Lord has caused me to be fruitful in*

the land of my affliction.” His family came to Egypt numbering 63 people and in the most difficult of circumstances they grew to a nation of 2 ½ or 3 million!)

Through this present difficulty God will teach us the grace He intends to bestow upon us and upon others. Psalm 84:5-7 (KJV) ***“Blessed is the man whose strength is in thee; in whose heart are the ways of them. ⁶ Who passing through the valley of Baca make it a well; the rain also filleth the pools. ⁷ They go from strength to strength, every one of them in Zion appeareth before God.”***

Joni Erickson Tada said, *"Faith isn't the ability to believe long and far into the misty future. It's simply taking God at His Word and taking the next step."*

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WE WILL TRUST GOD TO BRING US OUT IN HIS TIMING...

For 400 years the Children of Israel prayed for deliverance! It seemed that God would not answer their prayers!

They wanted deliverance but God intended restitution! They wanted God to take the jaws of life and extract them, with nothing to show for 400 years of work! Exodus 3:21 “*When you go, you shall not go empty.*” If all God had in mind was to deliver them, He could have accomplished that without a plague.

We often want deliverance but don't have the patience to trust the Lord for restitution! The problem with some of us is that our expectation is not in sync with the expectation of the Lord!

And for the rest of us, it could be that we are too traditional to transition!!! Difficult times demand that leaders be able to pivot! For a Pentecostal leader to pivot they must firmly

plant their doctrinal foot, and shift everything else if necessary, to meet the needs of the times. Isaiah 43:19 (NKJV) ***“Behold, I will do a new thing, Now it shall spring forth; Shall you not know it? I will even make a road in the wilderness And rivers in the desert.”***

CONCLUSION:

Goals Rider said, *“They say God's time is the best. But you have to believe that God's plan is the best also. Never Early, Never Late, Always on Time.”*

Deliverance often comes in our timing, if we want restitution, that can only come in God's timing! The how and when is up to Him and Him alone.

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